Byu Pathway Service Missionary Guidebook

This is a web-handbook that will be updated regularly

Welcome to BYU Pathway Service Mission! Pathway is constantly changing to accommodate our growth of students, classes, and service missionaries.

Because of this please check back regularly for updated information.
If you have any questions please contact your District Leaders or Zone Leaders.



"Our purpose is to help youth and young adults deepen their conversion to Jesus Christ and His restored gospel, qualify for the blessings of the temple, and prepare themselves, their families, and others for eternal life with their Father in Heaven."

Recent News

2026	Winter Semester		Spring Semester		Winter Semester	
	Term 1	**Term 2**	**Term 3**	**Term 4**	**Term 5**	**Term 6**
Start Mondays	January 5	March 2	May 4	June 29	August 31	October 26
End Saturdays	February 21	April 18	June 20	August 15	October 17	December 12
	1 Week break	**2 week break**	:There is a 1 week break between terms and 2 week break between semesters			

[Brother Christensen's Micro Training]

[Master List of trainings]

Teacher Expectations

Teacher expectations

- Attend Mission, Zone, and District meetings when held
- Zone and District leaders will help with Tech problems
- Watch Micro trainings that are sent out.
- Bro Christensen and Bro Fife will help you if you are struggling with an aspect of teaching that you want change or improve. We will observe classes occasionally to praise and offer support.



Your Zone Leaders

Sister Peterson (training zone) (Bro Christensen)
Elder and Sister Reed (Bro Christensen)
Elder Hopkins (Bro Fife)
Elder Hamblin (Bro Fife)
Elder Corbett (Canada) (Bro Fife)
Sister Black (Canada) (Bro Fife)

Yearly Compliance training: You will be contacted about this during the training period around August-October. This is standard Church workforce training and will need to be done every year, however some teachers are unable to log in. If you have this issue let your District Leader know.

Religion Courses information

What course will I be teaching?

Each term you will be assigned to teach one of the following seven courses offered to Pathway students. Students are invited but not required to register for classes in the following order:

REL 250: Jesus Christ and His Everlasting Gospel • Part A • Part B
REL 275: Teachings & Doctrine of the Book of Mormon • Part A • Part B
REL 225: Foundations of the Restoration • Part A • Part B
REL 200: The Eternal Family • Part A • Part B
REL 290: The Divine Gift of Forgiveness • Part A • Part B
REL 333: Teachings of the Living Prophets • Part A • Part B
REL 280: Answering My Gospel Questions • Part A • Part B

These are links to the SandBox courses.
There are no students or classes in these. Feel free to use them for Substituting or exploring classes you may be interested in teaching.

Courses have 28 weeks
Part A
Lessons 1-14
2 lessons per week

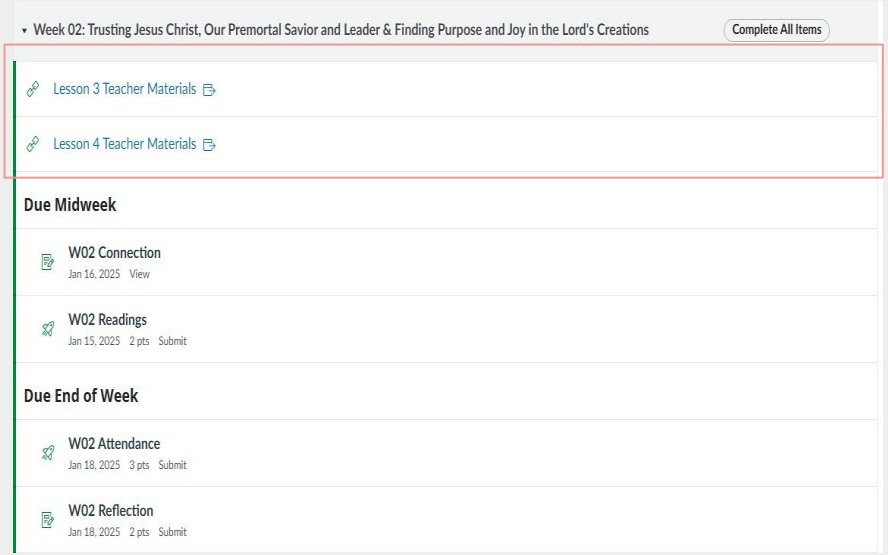
Part B
Lessons 15-28
2 lessons per week

What do students study? Students are given both topics to study and pick *one* lesson to study for the week

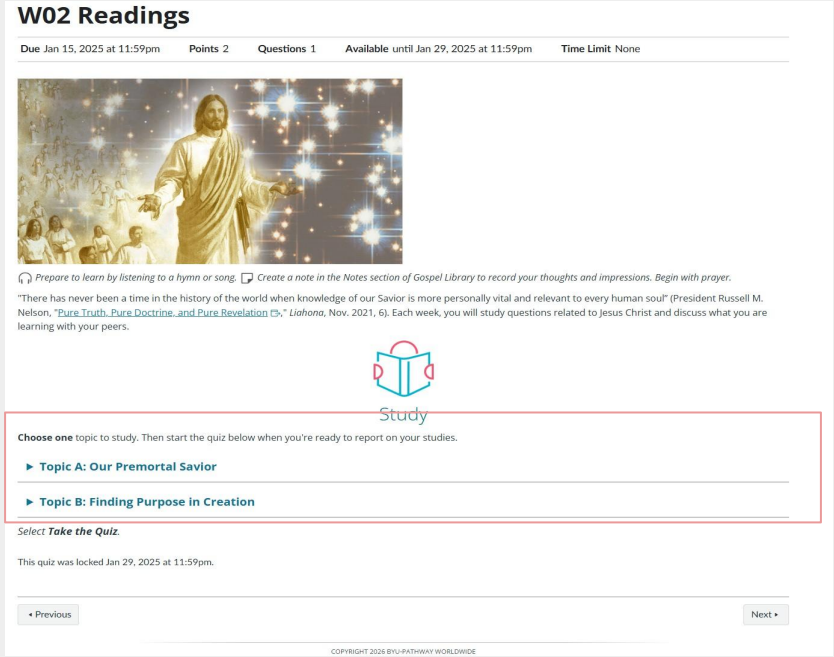
What do teachers study? Teachers discuss both topics/lessons each week
See Next Page for examples

Remember these are Discussion based classes. Students have already studied the subjects and your role is not to teach the material again, but to encourage them to dig deeper and help them connect the Saviors Gospel to their own lives.

Religion Courses information



This is what ***teachers*** see.
Notice there are lessons 3 & 4
You will study both lessons and discuss them in class. You will not get through everything in both lessons so prayerfully consider the needs of your class.



This is what the ***students*** will see. They choose **one** topic to study each week.

Zoom Settings and set up

First time log in

You will be emailed that you have been provisioned a pro zoom account. Using your BYU Pathway email you can log in and see your new pro Zoom account.

If you have not gotten this email you can still try to log in to see if the email was delayed.

Zoom Link

http://zoom.us/

You will use your **personal meeting room zoom link** for each class.
When you've logged in click on the ***meetings*** on the left side tab beside your profile.
Then ***Personal Meeting room***. On the top row.
The **blue link** is your personal meeting room zoom link.

**Make sure to copy this to your class, as well as your Zone Excel Teacher list.*

Zoom Settings

You must make sure your settings are correct for your class.

- Auto record on
- Waiting room disabled
- Students may join before host

These settings ensure substitutes may enter your class in an emergency.

For step by step instructions please follow this PDF that will show you exactly how to do this.

Zoom host Settings Instructions PDF

Zoom Alternate Host screencast

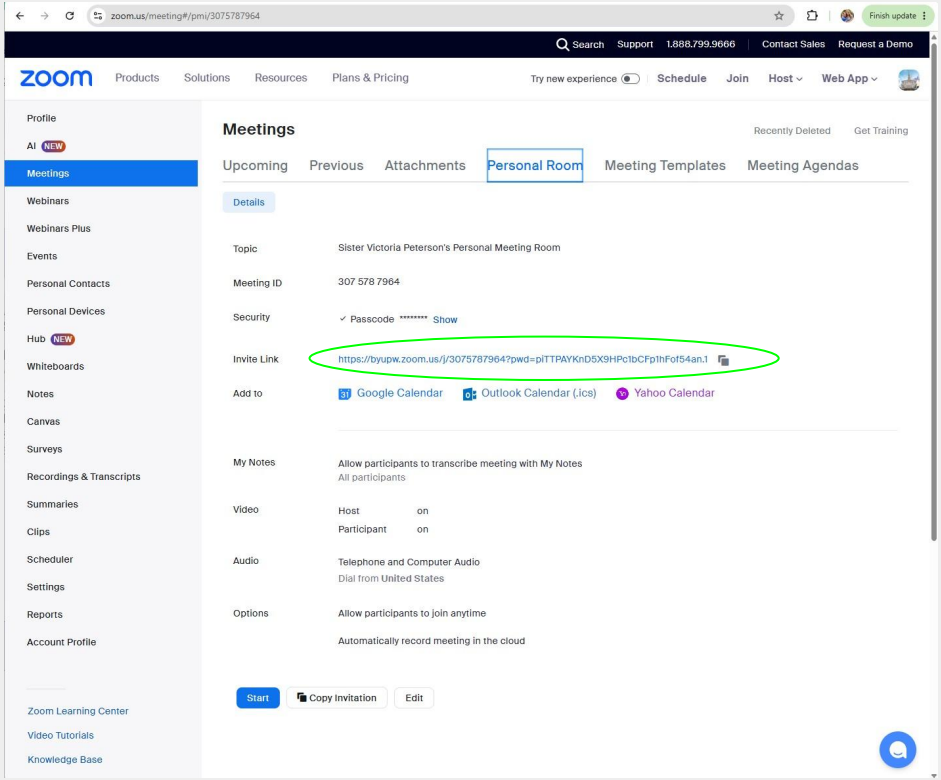
Zoom Alternate Host PDF

Zoom link

Which Zoom link should I use for class?

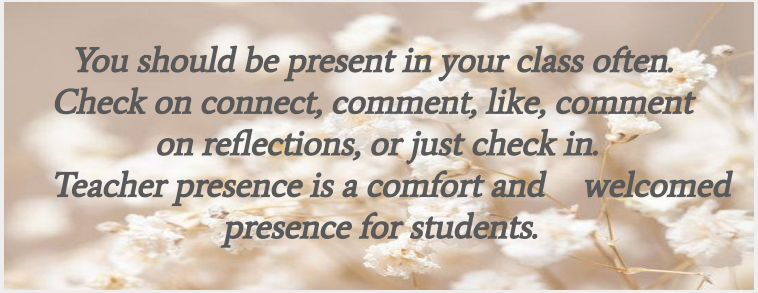
In *Meetings*
Under *Personal Room*
You'll see a blue link with *byupathways* on it.
That is the link you will use for all classes
Save it

*Do not use the zoom link from profile.
It looks like this
*https://byupw.zoom.us/j/*******964?pwd=piTTPAYKnD5X9HPc1bCFp1hFof54an.1*
This will not work



Canvas Settings and App

You should not see your training course on your canvas.
If you do your in the wrong one. (it may have no course, or an unpublished course)
Sign out by clicking the profile picture
Sign back in with your byu pathway email
If it still struggles sign in with an incognito window
Sign in using byupw.instructure.com



Canvas has a teacher app!

- ❏ Turn on notifications to get messages from students from your phone
- ❏ You can also grade reflections directly on the app
- ❏ Stay connected in the connect

CANVAS TEACHER

Resources available to you

Did you know that you have access to Office 365?
Office, Excel, Powerpoint, and more.
Just log in using your Byu Pathway email

Additional resources for lesson planning
Resources Microtraining

ldsbot.com
An AI chat bot that uses only LDS references for searches.
For questions like: *What are some conference talks that discuss Jesus Christ being the creator of the earth?*
Should only be used as a search engine for finding original references.
*All answers should be drawn from the original conference talks, scriptures, and references shown by the bot. It is still capable of mistakes. Never directly quote the bot.

Using AI:
AI is a useful tool for refining information, asking general questions and understanding policy.
It should never be used for spiritual guidance, reflections, or in the place of human communication.
***Good** for writing information communication.*
***Bad** for writing a spiritual message for your class.*

Can I use social media posts?
Yes, but only from the official church social media pages. Never use a video or picture from a secondary/fan account.

Can I use devotionals or Byu talks?
Yes, any talk given by the apostles and prophets can be used in class.

Can I show scenes from The Chosen?
No. While spiritual in nature and encouraging spiritually, The Chosen filming team is not in affiliation with the LDS church and cannot be used in official class curriculum.



Attendance

<u>Manual attendance must be taken for accurate records</u>
Zoom recordings, Zoom reports are inaccurate and do not reflect correct student count or time of attendance.
If a student does not turn on their camera for the duration of the class, or participate with audio or participate in chat they will not be anywhere on the recording.
User reports have stated that Zoom Reports also does not accurately reflect participants and the time attended.

What can I use for attendance?
This can be a paper, spreadsheet, or screenshot. (For international classes do your best, but remember that the main focus is the spirit of the class not attendance accuracy.)

According to the current syllabus, weekly Religion gatherings are an essential part of the course. Students are expected to attend, arrive on time, stay for the entire gathering, and participate. Missing gatherings or leaving early may negatively affect both their learning and their final grade.

<u>Students need to be present for **a majority of the class and participate fully**.</u>
Students are ***encouraged but not required*** to have cameras on, audio working, or participate in chat as much as possible.

Any policy for your particular class regarding attendance in your class (a point system or time frame requirement) must be communicated to students in <u>clear instructions</u>.



Missionary Care Package

Missionary Care Package

The missionary care package is sent to all new missionaries before the start of their first term.

New teacher checklist: Checklist for new teachers and weekly class checklist
Checklist

Introduction page/ Devotional sign up page: Instructions on how to insert an introduction page and devotional sign up into your course.
Introduction, Devotional

Instructor Standards and Expectations:
Docx

Zoom settings for personal meeting room/ substitute
Zoom settings

Reflections

Reflections

Encourage students to have a deep meaningful reflection.

For international classes
Google translate is an appropriate way to convey reflections when english skills feel lacking.
Using AI for reflections is not allowed. For international classes this may need to be reiterated.

If you suspect AI was used for a reflection:
Go to GPTZero.me copy and paste the reflection into the text box and press check.
It will tell you if it was human, or what percent was AI.
If it comes back as AI, respectfully contact your student and let them know they will need to resubmit their reflection to get full points.

Commenting on Reflections should always be with kindness and respect.
Using reflections in lessons, as examples, or quotes should always be with explicit permission from the student.

Elder Gong, June 2026 “Use Technology Wisely”
Artificial intelligence can answer questions, but it cannot answer prayers. It can organize information, but it cannot offer revelation, covenant connection, or divine truth.
In our personal lives, please use AI for logistics and drafts, but not as a substitute for trusted relationships. Set boundaries.

International classes

If you are an english speaker these courses will be in english.
Some students are new to english and may have a hard time reading or speaking without thick accents.
Closed caption can be turned on by clicking *More*.

Time zone

Make sure you are listing the class time accurate to the area of your class.
*I always list my time of meeting like this:
Class time: **Thursdays 5pm** (UTC-6) (Salt Lake City, Utah, USA Time- 8:00 pm)
*Google what time it is in Salt Lake City to make sure your on time for class.

Tips

- Set announcements to auto post one hour before class to remind students at the start of class time.
- No video? Ask student to change their profile pictures to a picture of themselves. That way you can see their faces instead of a black screen.
- Break out rooms: Even if you do not have a very talkative class, breakout rooms can encourage students who would not usually speak to feel like they have a space among peers to speak.
- Assigning a leader can help them draw others out of their shell.
- When struggling with communication remember to make things clear beyond just words. Big hellos and big goodbyes help students understand the beginning and end of class.

Whats app

This can be an encouraging tool for your class communication due to data costs for students.
However it is not required and should not be used in replacement of canvas or zoom. Prayerfully consider this resource for your particular class.

WhatsApp

Need training to use whatsapp?
Contact Brother Christensen, Brother Fief, or Sister Peterson

Remember that we are building the foundations of good student behavior with the mercy and grace of Christlike instruction. Be mindful, kind, and understanding that these students are doing their best and we have the opportunity to handle them with mercy.